OSHA Confined Space Checklist (29 CFR 1910.146)

Use at each permit-required confined space before authorizing entry and during the work.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.146

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. Record each Defect, tell the entry supervisor, and correct it before entry begins or continues.
3. Your permit space program, equipment manufacturers' instructions and site rules may add checks.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.146: Permit-required confined spaces (OSHA general industry) Source: eCFR, Title 29, Part 1910, Subpart J
Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-146-permit-required-confined-spaces

SECTION A | Space identification and program

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Workplace evaluation Ref. 1910.146(c)(1)	This space has been evaluated and classified as permit-required or non-permit.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Danger warning Ref. 1910.146(c)(2)	A danger sign or equally effective means at the space tells employees it is a permit space and what the danger is.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Unauthorized entry Ref. 1910.146(d)(1)	The program's measures to prevent unauthorized entry are in place at this space.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Written program Ref. 1910.146(c)(4)	The written permit space program is available for employees and their representatives to inspect.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Hazard evaluation Ref. 1910.146(d)(2)	The hazards of this space were identified and evaluated before anyone entered.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Changes to non-permit spaces Ref. 1910.146(c)(6)	Any change in use or configuration that might increase hazards has led to a reevaluation of the space.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Contractor informed Ref. 1910.146(c)(8)(i)	Any contractor entering has been told the site has permit spaces and entry requires a compliant program.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Permit and roles

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
8	Permit issued Ref. 1910.146(d)(10)	A permit for this entry was prepared and issued under the site's written permit system.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Acceptable entry conditions Ref. 1910.146(d)(3)(i)	The acceptable entry conditions for this space are specified.	☐	☐	☐	
10	Attendant posted Ref. 1910.146(d)(6)	At least one attendant is outside the space for the whole entry.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Permit and roles

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Multiple spaces Ref. 1910.146(d)(7)	If the attendant covers more than one space, the program sets out how they respond to an emergency in any of them.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Roles designated Ref. 1910.146(d)(8)	Entrants, attendant, entry supervisor and testers on this entry are designated, know their duties and have had the required training.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Communications equipment Ref. 1910.146(d)(4)(iii)	Communications equipment is provided and working for contact between entrants and the attendant.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Multi-employer coordination Ref. 1910.146(d)(11)	Where entrants from more than one employer work at once, coordination procedures are in use.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Atmosphere, isolation and equipment

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
15	Pre-entry test Ref. 1910.146(d)(5)(i)	Conditions were tested and found acceptable before entry was authorized.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Test order Ref. 1910.146(d)(5)(iii)	Oxygen was tested first, then combustible gases and vapors, then toxic gases and vapors.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Testing during entry Ref. 1910.146(d)(5)(ii)	The space is tested or monitored as needed to show acceptable conditions are maintained.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Entrants can observe testing Ref. 1910.146(d)(5)(iv)	Entrants or their representatives were offered the chance to watch the testing.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Results shared Ref. 1910.146(d)(5)(vi)	Test results were given to entrants or their representatives as soon as they were available.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Isolation Ref. 1910.146(d)(3)(iii)	The space is isolated, for example by blanking, double block and bleed or lockout, as the program requires.	☐	☐	☐	
21	Atmospheric control Ref. 1910.146(d)(3)(iv)	Purging, inerting, flushing or ventilating is done as necessary to eliminate or control atmospheric hazards.	☐	☐	☐	
22	External barriers Ref. 1910.146(d)(3)(v)	Pedestrian, vehicle or other barriers protect entrants from outside hazards where needed.	☐	☐	☐	
23	Lighting Ref. 1910.146(d)(4)(v)	Lighting lets entrants see well enough to work safely and exit quickly in an emergency.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Ingress and egress Ref. 1910.146(d)(4)(vii)	Ladders or other equipment for safe entry and exit are in place.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Rescue and close-out

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
25	Summoning rescue Ref. 1910.146(d)(9)	A procedure for calling rescue and emergency services is in place and known to the entry team.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION D | Rescue and close-out

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
26	Rescue procedure Ref. 1910.146(d)(9)	A procedure for getting entrants out of this space is in place.	☐	☐	☐	
27	No unauthorized rescue Ref. 1910.146(d)(9)	Procedures stop unauthorized personnel from attempting a rescue.	☐	☐	☐	
28	Rescue equipment Ref. 1910.146(d)(4)(viii)	The employer has provided the rescue and emergency equipment the rescue procedures need, except to the extent the rescue service provides it.	☐	☐	☐	
29	Conditions verified throughout Ref. 1910.146(d)(3)(vi)	Conditions are checked and stay acceptable for the full duration of the entry.	☐	☐	☐	
30	Entry concluded Ref. 1910.146(d)(12)	After the work, the space is closed off and the permit canceled under the concluding procedure.	☐	☐	☐	
31	Program review Ref. 1910.146(d)(13)	Any unauthorized entry, uncovered hazard, prohibited condition, injury or near-miss led to a program review before the next entry.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME